    - It has a unique address that can be used to identify the data product.
- It is secured.
    - It can be accessed only by authorized entities.
- It can be used.
    - It has sufficient data to be used on its own (i.e., carries sufficient domain sense on its own).
    - You can combine it with other data; it has metadata and references that allow you to combine several data products into a larger whole.
    - It is accessible through publicly known and available protocols and tools.
- You can tell its availability and quality through metrics, user feedback, and quality reports.

The data product has to meet many criteria to be a full-fledged product. Metadata, which is described in the following paragraphs, plays an especially important role in this regard.

5.5.1 Self-described data product

The data product should contain all the information to understand and use it. This characteristic is achieved through an appropriate set of metadata.

In classical data management approaches, metadata is often separated from the dataset and tends to be scattered in many places. One of the fundamental properties of a data product is its autonomy. And autonomy means independence from specific solutions and that everything important about the data product will be found in one place, including metadata. While in data management in general “metadata is king,” in the data mesh approach metadata becomes the fuel that drives the data product. Metadata is where all the key information for the data is defined.

5.5.2 Introduction to metadata

Metadata is data about data. It is mainly used to provide additional information about the data so that it is easier to understand and use with